



7 mistakes Police Officers do with their tax

1. Not claiming all car kms pertaining to working as a trainee or registered Police. Some examples are car kms for:

- Directly between two separate workplaces because you have two different employers (for example, you have a second job)
- For work-related purposes from your normal workplace to an alternative workplace that is not a regular workplace and back to your normal workplace or directly home (for example, if you need to go to another hospital for a meeting)
- Between two workplaces that are not regular workplaces or between a workplace that is not a regular workplace and a place of business (for example, between two hospitals)
- Between home and work, only if
 - you have to carry bulky tools or equipment, at least 20kgs, that you use for work and there is no secure area for storing your tools or equipment at work
 - your home is considered a base of employment and you either commence work at home and travel directly to another base of employment to continue working, or travel from another base of employment to home to continue working
 - you travel from your home to an alternative workplace, that is not a regular workplace, for work activities and then to your normal workplace or directly home.

2. Forgetting Travel expenses for nursing related work as follows:

You can claim work-related travel expenses for:

- using vehicles other than cars as well as parking fees and tolls (parking at or travelling to a regular workplace is not ordinarily considered to be a work-related use of the vehicle)
- costs associated with taxis or short-term car hire.

3. Not writing off uniform allowances and claiming all items of a police officer's uniform; including non-slip shoes, dry cleaning, home laundry, and alterations / repairs to police officer's clothing.

4. Not claiming self-education courses and conferences directly related to gaining more knowledge in medical procedures including time spent and the cost of online studies.

5. forgetting about police officers' union being directly debited from a bank account or deducted from a payslip and also not forgetting police officer's registration fees.

- **Union and professional association fees** – you can claim a deduction for these fees. If the amount you paid is shown on your payment summary, you can use it to prove your claim. You can claim a deduction for a levy paid in certain circumstances, for example, to protect the interests of members and their jobs.

6. not keeping a compulsory 6-week telephone diary of any work related expenses to do with the use of a mobile telephone or internet fees used for work related purposes or study of any kind.

7. Other expenses police officers sometimes forget

Here is a list of other expenses commonly incurred by police officers but sometimes forgotten. You can't claim costs met by your employer or costs that are reimbursed.

- **Capital allowances** for equipment you may be able to claim a capital allowance deduction less than \$300, including:
 - calculators and electronic organisers
 - computers and computer software
 - answering machines, phones, facsimile machines, mobile phones, pagers and other telecommunications equipment
 - a professional library
 - tools and equipment
 - dedicated stopwatches and fob watches (but not ordinary wristwatches).
- **Agency commissions and agency fees** – you can claim a deduction for commission payments you made to a nursing agency. You can't claim
 - if your employer has paid the commission payment
 - for upfront fees, joining fees or search fees paid to a nursing agency.
- **Annual practising certificate fees** – you can claim a deduction for the cost of renewing your annual practising certificate.
- **First aid courses** – you can claim a deduction for the cost of first aid training courses if you, as a designated first aid person, are

required to undertake first aid training to assist in emergency work situations.

- **Home office** – you may be entitled to claim deductions for running costs, however, occupancy expenses are generally not deductible for an employee.

- **Interest costs** – you can claim the cost of interest on money borrowed to purchase work-related equipment. If the equipment was also used for private purposes, you can't claim a deduction for that part of the interest.
- **Seminars, conferences and training courses** – you can claim a deduction for the cost of attending seminars, conferences and training courses that are sufficiently connected to your work activities.
- **Stationery** – you can claim a deduction for the cost of street directories, logbooks, diaries, pens and other stationery to the extent that you use them for work.
- **Technical or professional publications** – you can claim a deduction for the cost of journals, periodicals and magazines that have a content specifically related to your employment as a police officers.
- **Repairs to tools and equipment** – you can claim a deduction for the cost of repairing tools and equipment for work. If the tools or equipment were also used for private purposes, you can't claim a deduction for that part of the repair cost.

7. Expenses you can't claim Claiming items of expenditure which are not relevant to the job or which are of a private nature such as food, grooming and other personal items

Items you cannot claim in your nursing profession:

Car expenses you can't claim

You can't claim a deduction for the cost of:

- travelling to another hospital or other workplace for a social function
- using your car to travel between your home and work
 - if the travel is a normal trip between your home and your workplace; it is a private expense, even if you do small tasks on your way to or from work such as picking up mail for the hospital, or
 - just because you do shift work, you are on call or there is no public transport available
- car expenses if your employer or any other person provides a car for you and you do not pay for any of the running costs (such as petrol, repairs and other maintenance costs). This includes a car provided under a salary sacrifice arrangement
- any expenses you incur for the direct operation of a car that your employer provides and that you or your relatives use privately at any time, even if the expenses are work related. This includes a car provided under a salary sacrifice arrangement. Such expenses form part of the valuation of the car for fringe benefits tax purposes.
- the cost of meals incurred during a normal working day that does not involve an overnight stay, even if you receive a travel allowance
- costs met by your employer or costs that are reimbursed.



Travel expenses you can't claim

You can't claim:

- the cost of meals incurred during a normal working day that does not involve an overnight stay, even if you receive a travel allowance
- costs met by your employer or costs that are reimbursed.

Clothing expenses you can't claim

You can't claim:

- a deduction for the cost of purchasing or cleaning a plain uniform or conventional clothing worn at work, even if your employer tells you to wear them, as it is a private expense. This includes expenditure by employee police officers on
 - clothing worn for medical reasons (for example, support stockings)
 - conventional clothing that is damaged at work
 - everyday footwear (for example, dress, casual or running shoes). You can claim a deduction for the cost of special non-slip nursing shoes
- costs met by your employer or costs that are reimbursed.

Self-education expenses you can't claim

You are not eligible to claim a deduction for your self-education expenses if:

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- you are not earning income relevant to the type of study you are undertaking
- you were only working casually to support yourself whilst studying and can't show the subject or subjects are relevant to the duties you currently perform
- the only income you received was from youth allowance, Au study, ABSTUDY or similar payments providing financial assistance
- the claim is for repayments you make on loans you have with the
 - Student Financial Supplement Scheme (SFSS)
 - Higher Education Loan Program (HELP)
 - Student Start-up Loan (SSL)
 - Trade Support Loan (TSL)
- it's for the cost of meals, other than listed above.

It is not sufficient to show that a course:

- might be generally related to your current employment, or
- enables you to get new employment.

Meal expenses

You can't claim a deduction for the cost of meals eaten during a normal working day as it is a private expense, even if you receive an allowance to cover the meal expense.

Phone calls, phone rental and connection costs

You can't claim a deduction for the cost of:

- connecting a phone, mobile phone, pager or any other telecommunications equipment as it is a capital expense
- an unlisted phone number (silent number) as it is a private expense.



Conclusion & recommendation

You should leave it up to the experts to get your best possible tax refund without breaking any tax laws and legislation

Try our police officers tax on line services to get you back the best possible refund.

All tax returns are checked by senior tax accountants who have been highly trained in the police officer's field of work. Download our extensive free police officers tax deductions worksheets to assist you complete your tax online within 10 minutes.

Our premium services have a live chat function to also assist in the preparation of your tax. The end tax result is back to your screen within 80 seconds for you to accept or make further changes of any items.

We also have a skype accountant who specialises in police officer's tax returns,

Call us on 1800 316 360 or register on line from our web site and our receptionist who has been a police officer at a major hospital will book you in for you skype appointment.